

Getting Over a Breakup

Moving through heartbreak, and coming back to life

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Moving through heartbreak, and coming back to life

A breakup is grief: sorrow, longing, anger, doubt. It's normal to hurt, even when it was the right decision.

This guide supports you in understanding what you're going through, easing the thoughts that prolong the pain, and rebuilding — at your pace.

Your intention

What hurts you most since the breakup: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

Understanding heartbreak

A breakup triggers a real grief process, in waves: denial, anger, sadness, then acceptance — rarely in order. If it hurts this much, it's the measure of the attachment.

Hurting isn't weakness: it's human.

Example

Camille blamed herself for 'not being over it' after two months. Understanding grief's waves eased her.

Where I am

What emotions move through you right now? Write them without judging.

What I'm really losing

Beyond the person, what do you miss (security, plans, habits)?

→ *My sorrow is the measure of my attachment — it's human.*

The thoughts that prolong the pain

'I'll never find that again', 'it's my fault', idealizing the ex and rumination: these thoughts keep the pain alive far beyond what's needed.

Softening them helps you move forward.

Example

Nia idealized her ex on a loop. Also writing the reality (what was wrong) loosened the grip.

Anti-rumination journal

Note: the looping thought · a more realistic version.

Reality, not idealization

List what, in the relationship, didn't truly suit you.

→ *I remember the reality — not just an idealized version.*

Recentering on yourself

A breakup can also be a rebirth: reclaiming your footing, your desires, your worth outside the couple. You exist fully, without this relationship.

This time for yourself isn't emptiness: it's rebuilding.

Example

Reconnecting with what she loved 'before', Léa rediscovered a part of herself she'd paused.

Finding myself

List what you want to reclaim or explore now that you have this space.

My worth, beyond the couple

Write 5 qualities that are yours, independent of any relationship.

→ *I exist fully — this breakup reopens space for me.*

Rebuilding concretely

Concretely: limit contact (and online 'stalking'), build support, allow yourself a closure ritual, resume projects, and let time do its work.

If distress lasts or worsens, support truly helps.

Example

By unfollowing her ex's socials and reinvesting in friends, Sofia felt the pain recede.

My safeguards

What limits do I set (contact, socials) to protect myself?

My closure ritual

Write a letter you won't send, to say what's left to say.

→ *Protecting myself and building support is how I let myself be reborn.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Welcome the emotional waves without judging them: they pass.
- Limit contact and online 'stalking' — it reopens the wound.
- Don't idealize the ex: remember the reality too.
- Lean on loved ones and resume activities that do you good.
- A closure ritual helps (an unsent letter, a symbol).
- Give yourself time. If distress lasts or worsens, ask for help.

To fill in

Anti-rumination journal

The looping thought	A more realistic version

My rebuilding

What I reclaim for myself	My protective limit

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Understand where I am in grief.

Week 2 — Ease the thoughts that prolong the pain.

Week 3 — Recenter on myself.

Week 4 — Rebuild & protect myself.

Your plan in 3 lines

- The emotion I allow myself:
- The reality I keep in mind:
- My protective limit:

TO CLOSE

**Heartbreak can be moved through — at your pace,
you'll be reborn.**

Heartbreak can be moved through.

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not a substitute for therapy. If you are going through a hard time, please reach out to a professional or a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.